KD

PROFESSIONAL REFERRAL FIT GUIDE

Who is a good fit for Bracket Planning?

A practical guide for referrals involving incorporated professionals, business owners, and families with corporate, tax, retirement, and estate complexity.

Bracket Planning

BA, B.Comm., MA, CFP, CLU, TEP, ICD.D | Alberta | St. John's

NO PRODUCT SALES

TRANSPARENT FEES

BEST FIT

Clients whose personal, corporate, tax, and estate decisions need to work together.

Bracket Planning is especially well suited for clients who need coordinated planning across compensation, retained earnings, retirement income, estate planning, insurance review, and family wealth transfer.

CLIENT PROFILE	PLANNING NEED
Incorporated professionals	Salary, dividends, retained earnings, corporate investments, personal cash flow, retirement income, and long-term tax strategy.
Business owners	Succession, corporate wind-down, retained earnings withdrawal, shareholder agreements, and transition from business income to retirement income.
Families with complexity	Estate equalization, trusts, gifting, capital gains exposure, blended family issues, liquidity needs, and family harmony.
Retiring professionals and owners	Coordinating corporate assets, RRSP/RRIF withdrawals, CPP/OAS timing, taxable income, and sustainable spending.
Clients with retained earnings	Clarifying what stays corporate, what moves personal, and how withdrawals affect tax, retirement income, and estate value.
Families preparing for transfer	Intergenerational transfer, estate liquidity, beneficiary planning, charitable intent, and preparing heirs for responsibility.

REFERRAL CONTEXT

When to refer, and how collaboration works.

Use these triggers when a client needs planning strategy beyond tax preparation or product recommendations.

COMMON SITUATIONS

- A client asks how to pay themselves from a corporation.
- A client is unsure how to draw from registered, non-registered, or corporate assets.
- A client wants help timing CPP or OAS.
- A client has retained earnings and no clear withdrawal plan.
- A client needs estate equalization among children.

MAY NOT BE A FIT

- Clients looking only for investment management.
- Clients with very simple finances and no current planning need.
- Clients who primarily need tax return preparation.
- Clients who primarily need legal drafting.
- Clients seeking a product recommendation without a broader plan.

ACCOUNTANT COLLABORATION

Supporting the client while respecting your relationship.

Ken helps the client clarify the planning strategy, model decisions, and identify tax-sensitive tradeoffs. The accountant remains the client's tax preparation and tax compliance professional.

Where coordination can help

- Salary and dividend planning
- Retained earnings strategy
- RRSP/RRIF withdrawal strategy
- CPP and OAS timing
- Corporate withdrawals
- Taxable income smoothing
- Capital gains planning
- Estate and beneficiary considerations

PROCESS AND FEES

A clear engagement from intro call to ongoing review.

Clients receive a comprehensive planning process, transparent fees, and a practical referral introduction.

HOW CLIENTS WORK WITH KEN

STEP 01

Intro call

Discuss the client's situation, goals, complexity, and whether planning support is a fit.

STEP 02

Gather details

Income, assets, liabilities, pensions, insurance, tax details, corporate information, family context, and estate goals.

STEP 03

Build plan

A roadmap across compensation, corporate assets, retirement income, tax, investments, risk, estate, and wealth transfer.

STEP 04

Prioritize

Clear recommendations and a practical action list explained in plain language.

STEP 05

Review

Ongoing retainer support, annual reviews, and year-round access when appropriate.

FEE POSITIONING

Transparent, disclosed-up-front fees.

Fees are discussed and agreed upon before the engagement begins. Current website examples include:

FOUNDATION PLANNING	INTEGRATED WEALTH PLANNING	PRIVATE CLIENT PLANNING
$4,200	$5,400	$6,600
ANNUAL RETAINER	ANNUAL RETAINER	ANNUAL RETAINER

Fees do not include GST. Plan-only options are available at 20% above the annual retainer for the relevant planning tier.

SUGGESTED REFERRAL NOTE

> I wanted to introduce you to Bracket Planning, an independent fee-only financial planning firm. The team works with incorporated professionals, business owners, and families whose corporate, tax, retirement, and estate decisions need to be coordinated. They do not sell investment products or charge based on assets under management, which is why I thought they could be a good fit for this question.